THE Estate Organizer

A FREE GUIDE · THE ESTATE ORGANIZER

The Executor Toolkit

AMERICAN EDITION

Everything the person who steps up needs: a clear path through the first days and the months that follow.

- The first 48 hours, step by step
- The executor timeline, week by week
- Common executor mistakes to avoid
- Expense log and notification templates

"Being an executor is hard enough. This makes it simpler."

A FREE GUIDE FROM THE ESTATE ORGANISER

theestateorganiser.com

GENERAL INFORMATION ONLY. NOT LEGAL, FINANCIAL OR TAX ADVICE.
LAWS VARY BY STATE. CONSULT A QUALIFIED PROFESSIONAL.

Executor Roadmap & First 48 Hours Checklist

The first 48 hours after a death are chaotic.

Your executor will be dealing with their own grief while also handling urgent practical matters. They need to secure property, notify key people, and start organizing paperwork.

This checklist helps them prioritize what needs to happen immediately and what can wait.

The first 48 hours: Secure, Notify, Record

Your Executor Roadmap & First 48 Hours Checklist

A step-by-step path through the first hours and days, so nothing urgent is missed.

WITHIN THE FIRST FEW HOURS

- [ ] Secure the person's home (lock up, set alarm, collect mail, pets, plants)
- [ ] Locate the Will (check Part 2; contact the lawyer who drafted it)
- [ ] Locate this Estate Organizer and read the Message to Your Executor
- [ ] Contact immediate family (see Key Contacts)

WITHIN THE FIRST 24 HOURS

- [ ] Obtain the Death certificate
- [ ] Register the death (your funeral director usually handles this; how it works and the timing vary by state, so check with them, and it's worth ordering a few certified copies of the death certificate, as several organizations will ask for one)
- [ ] Contact the funeral director (check the Funeral chapter for wishes)
- [ ] Notify the deceased's employer (final pay, leave, retirement savings)
- [ ] Secure valuable items (jewelry, cash, documents) and record them

Your Executor Roadmap & First 48 Hours Checklist (cont.)

WITHIN THE FIRST 48 HOURS

- [ ] Notify close friends (see Key Contacts)
- [ ] Contact the lawyer
- [ ] Contact insurance companies (if death benefits apply)
- [ ] Arrange care for dependents
- [ ] Arrange care for pets
- [ ] Cancel immediate appointments
- [ ] Start a death administration notebook

NOTES: WHAT'S BEEN DONE, AND WHAT STILL NEEDS DOING

Executor Timeline

Being an executor is a marathon, not a sprint.

The work doesn't end after the first week. Settling an estate typically takes 6-12 months (sometimes longer if it's complicated).

This timeline breaks down what needs to happen at each stage: the first week, the first month, the first three months, and the first year.

Use this as a guide, not a strict schedule. Every estate is different. Some things will take longer than expected. Some will move faster. That's normal.

Your timeline: What to expect and when

Your Executor Timeline

What to do and when, from the first week through to the end of the first year.

THE FIRST WEEK

- [ ] Secure the property and valuables
- [ ] Register the death (usually handled by your funeral director; timeframes vary by state, and order multiple certificates)
- [ ] Arrange the funeral
- [ ] Locate the Will and this Estate Organizer
- [ ] Contact the lawyer
- [ ] Notify immediate family and close friends
- [ ] Secure all financial documents
- [ ] Start keeping detailed records

THE FIRST MONTH

- [ ] Apply for probate if it's required (whether you need it, and how long it takes, varies by state, so check your state's probate court or ask the lawyer what applies)
- [ ] Notify all relevant organizations (banks, retirement savings, Social Security, insurers)
- [ ] Cancel or transfer services
- [ ] Secure and value all assets
- [ ] Identify all debts
- [ ] Claim life insurance
- [ ] Claim retirement plan (401(k)/IRA) death benefits
- [ ] Keep paying urgent bills

Your Executor Timeline (cont.)

THE FIRST THREE MONTHS

- [ ] Obtain Letters Testamentary (if applicable)
- [ ] Open an estate bank account
- [ ] Collect all assets
- [ ] Pay debts in the order that applies in your state (the priority of different debts varies, and paying them in the wrong order can create problems, so confirm the order with the lawyer first)
- [ ] File the final tax return
- [ ] Deal with property
- [ ] Manage business interests (if applicable)
- [ ] Cancel digital accounts (if instructed)
- [ ] Respond to creditors

THE FIRST SIX MONTHS

- [ ] Prepare estate accounts
- [ ] Obtain IRS clearance
- [ ] Prepare distribution schedule
- [ ] Communicate with beneficiaries
- [ ] Resolve any disputes

Your Executor Timeline (cont.)

THE FIRST YEAR

- [ ] Distribute the estate
- [ ] Finalize estate accounts
- [ ] Close the estate bank account
- [ ] Retain records
- [ ] If you're entitled to a fee for acting as executor, claim it properly. Whether you can be paid, and how much, depends on your state, the Will, and sometimes the beneficiaries or the court, so check with the lawyer first and keep it documented.

NOTES: PROGRESS, DATES, AND ANYTHING OUTSTANDING

Common Executor Pitfalls & How to Avoid Them

Being an executor is harder than most people think.

There are legal requirements, financial complexities, and emotional landmines. It's easy to make mistakes, especially when you're grieving and under pressure from family.

This section covers the most common pitfalls executors face and how to avoid them.

Learn from other people's mistakes so you don't have to make them yourself.

Common mistakes and how to avoid them

PITFALL 1: Distributing assets too soon

THE MISTAKE: Executors sometimes distribute assets to beneficiaries before all debts are paid and all claims are settled. Then a creditor appears, or a tax bill arrives, and there's no money left to pay it.

HOW TO AVOID IT:

- Don't distribute anything until you have IRS clearance
- Wait until all debts are paid
- Wait until the required creditor-notice period for your state expires
- Keep a reserve in the estate account for unexpected expenses
- If there's any pressure to distribute early, talk to the lawyer first. Beneficiary agreement on its own may not protect you if a debt or tax bill turns up later, so get advice before releasing anything ahead of time.

PITFALL 2: Not keeping detailed records

THE MISTAKE: Executors fail to document their actions, expenses, and decisions. Later, beneficiaries question what happened, and the executor can't prove what they did or why.

HOW TO AVOID IT:

- Start a detailed record-keeping system from day one
- Document every phone call, letter, email, and meeting
- Keep all receipts for expenses (even small ones)
- Take photos of property before selling or distributing
- Keep copies of everything
- Use Section 41 (Executor Expense Log) to track costs

PITFALL 3: Paying debts in the wrong order

THE MISTAKE: Not all debts are equal. Some must be paid first (like funeral costs and tax debts). Executors who pay debts in the wrong order can be held personally liable.

HOW TO AVOID IT:

- Work with a lawyer to understand debt priority
- Some debts have to be paid before others, and getting the order wrong can leave you personally on the hook. The exact priority is set by your state's law, so don't work it out from a general list. Ask the lawyer to confirm the correct order for this estate before you pay anyone.
- Don't pay anyone until you know the full picture

PITFALL 4: Mixing personal and estate funds

THE MISTAKE: Executors use their own money to pay estate expenses, or they deposit estate money into their personal account. This creates confusion and can look like mismanagement.

HOW TO AVOID IT:

- Open a separate estate bank account immediately
- All estate income goes into this account
- All estate expenses are paid from this account
- Never mix it with your personal finances
- Keep the estate account separate until the estate is fully settled

PITFALL 5: Acting without probate when it's required

THE MISTAKE: Some executors try to access bank accounts, sell property, or distribute assets before getting Letters Testamentary. Banks and institutions won't cooperate, and it wastes time.

HOW TO AVOID IT:

- Check with the lawyer whether probate is needed
- If required, apply for it before trying to access assets
- Smaller estates sometimes qualify for a simpler process instead of full probate, but whether this estate does depends on your state's rules, so check with the lawyer.
- Wait for the Grant before taking action on major assets

PITFALL 6: Ignoring or delaying communication with beneficiaries

THE MISTAKE: Executors go silent. Beneficiaries don't know what's happening, assume the worst, and start making accusations or legal threats.

HOW TO AVOID IT:

- Send regular updates to beneficiaries (monthly or quarterly)
- Be transparent about timelines and delays
- Explain what you're doing and why
- Manage expectations (estates take time)
- Respond to questions promptly

PITFALL 7: Taking on too much alone

THE MISTAKE: Executors try to do everything themselves to save money. They get overwhelmed, make mistakes, and the estate takes years to settle.

HOW TO AVOID IT:

- Hire a lawyer. Yes, it costs money, but it's worth it.
- Use an accountant for tax matters
- Engage professionals for valuations (property, business, collectibles)
- Don't be a hero. This is too complex to do alone.

PITFALL 8: Selling assets too quickly (or too slowly)

THE MISTAKE: Executors panic-sell property at a loss because they feel pressured. Or they delay selling for years, racking up maintenance costs and frustrating beneficiaries.

HOW TO AVOID IT:

- Get professional valuations before selling anything
- Consult beneficiaries about major sales (if appropriate)
- Don't rush, but don't delay unnecessarily
- Consider market conditions (especially for property)
- Check the Will for specific instructions about selling

PITFALL 9: Not advertising for creditors

THE MISTAKE: Executors forget to advertise for creditors. A creditor appears after the estate is distributed, and the executor is personally liable.

HOW TO AVOID IT:

- Your lawyer will handle this
- Required by law in most states
- Advertise in newspapers and online

- required notice period for creditor claims (length varies by state)
- Don't distribute until the period expires

PITFALL 10: Paying themselves without documentation

THE MISTAKE: Executors take a fee without documenting it or getting beneficiary approval. Beneficiaries accuse them of theft.

HOW TO AVOID IT:

- Executors can usually be paid for their work, but how the fee is worked out depends on your state, the Will, and sometimes the court. Document your time, be transparent with the beneficiaries, and check with the lawyer what a reasonable fee looks like in your state before claiming anything.
- Document your time and effort
- Get written approval from beneficiaries before taking a fee
- Be transparent about what you're claiming
- Consult your lawyer about reasonable fees

PITFALL 11: Assuming the Will is clear when it's not

THE MISTAKE: The Will says "divide my estate equally among my children," but one child is estranged, or one was already given money during life. Executors guess what the deceased meant.

HOW TO AVOID IT:

- If the Will is unclear, get legal advice
- Don't interpret it yourself
- Courts can provide guidance on ambiguous Wills
- Check this organizer for additional context (especially Part 8)

PITFALL 12: Not dealing with digital assets

THE MISTAKE: Executors forget about online accounts, subscriptions, cryptocurrency, and digital photos. The estate keeps getting charged, or valuable assets are lost.

HOW TO AVOID IT:

- Check Sections 20-23 for digital asset details
- Cancel subscriptions to stop charges
- Access cryptocurrency with recovery phrases (don't lose them)
- Download photos and important files before closing accounts

PITFALL 13: Letting family pressure influence decisions

THE MISTAKE: A beneficiary pressures the executor to give them "their share" early, or to interpret the Will in their favor. The executor caves to keep the peace.

HOW TO AVOID IT:

- Your job is to follow the Will, not make everyone happy
- Don't be pushed into handing out anything early. If there's pressure to distribute ahead of time, check with the lawyer what's allowed in your state before you do.
- Don't let anyone bully you
- Refer difficult family members to the lawyer
- Document any pressure or threats

PITFALL 14: Not valuing assets properly

THE MISTAKE: Executors guess at asset values instead of getting professional valuations. This causes disputes and potential tax issues.

HOW TO AVOID IT:

- Get professional valuations for:
- Property
- Vehicles
- Businesses
- Collectibles
- Jewelry
- Art
- Keep valuation reports for your records
- Use valuations as of the date of death

PITFALL 15: Missing tax deadlines

THE MISTAKE: Executors don't realize the final tax return is due, or they miss the deadline. The IRS charges penalties and interest.

HOW TO AVOID IT:

- Work with the accountant (Section 19 has details)
- There's usually a final personal tax return to file after a death, and there can be deadlines that matter. The exact forms and due dates depend on the timing and the estate, so work with the accountant early so nothing is missed.
- Don't distribute the estate until you have IRS clearance
- Keep funds in reserve for potential tax bills

PITFALL 16: Not understanding retirement savings

THE MISTAKE: Executors assume retirement savings go to the estate automatically. It doesn't. Retirement savings are paid according to the beneficiary designation, not the Will.

HOW TO AVOID IT:

- Check Section 11 for retirement savings details
- Contact the retirement savings fund immediately
- Check for your named beneficiary designations

- Beneficiary designations should be reviewed regularly (check the date)
- Retirement savings can be paid to dependents or the estate

PITFALL 17: Underestimating how long it takes

THE MISTAKE: Executors tell beneficiaries "this will be done in a few months." A year later, it's still not settled, and everyone is angry.

HOW TO AVOID IT:

- Set realistic expectations from the start
- Set realistic expectations early. Let beneficiaries know that settling an estate often takes many months, sometimes longer, and that delays are normal, rather than promising a specific timeframe you can't control.
- Explain that delays are normal
- Update them regularly on progress
- Don't promise timelines you can't control

SUMMARY: THE GOLDEN RULES

1. Don't rush. Take your time and get it right.
2. Keep detailed records. Document everything.
3. Get professional help. Lawyers and accountants are worth it.
4. Communicate with beneficiaries. Transparency prevents conflict.
5. Follow the Will. Not family pressure.
6. Don't distribute until debts are paid and IRS clearance is received.
7. Open a separate estate bank account.
8. Get professional valuations.
9. Be patient with yourself. This is hard work.

You're doing your best. That's all anyone can ask.

Your Common Executor Pitfalls & How to Avoid Them

The mistakes that catch executors out, and a box to tick once you understand each.

PITFALLS TO UNDERSTAND AND AVOID

Each pitfall is explained above. Tick it once you understand how to avoid it.

- [ ] 1. Distributing assets too soon (wait for IRS clearance and the creditor period)
- [ ] 2. Not keeping detailed records
- [ ] 3. Paying debts in the wrong order
- [ ] 4. Mixing personal and estate funds
- [ ] 5. Acting without probate when it's required
- [ ] 6. Ignoring or delaying communication with beneficiaries
- [ ] 7. Taking on too much alone
- [ ] 8. Selling assets too quickly (or too slowly)
- [ ] 9. Not advertising for creditors
- [ ] 10. Paying themselves without documentation
- [ ] 11. Assuming the Will is clear when it's not
- [ ] 12. Not dealing with digital assets
- [ ] 13. Letting family pressure influence decisions
- [ ] 14. Not valuing assets properly
- [ ] 15. Missing tax deadlines
- [ ] 16. Not understanding retirement savings
- [ ] 17. Underestimating how long it takes

NOTES: WHICH OF THESE APPLY TO THIS ESTATE, AND HOW YOU'LL HANDLE THEM

Executor Expense Log Template

As an executor, you'll spend money on behalf of the estate.

Lawyer fees. Accountant fees. Funeral costs. Property valuations. Travel expenses. Postage. Death certificates. Probate application fees.

All of these costs are paid from the estate, not from your own pocket. But you need to keep detailed records of every expense to prove what you spent and why.

This expense log helps you track everything.

Why keep detailed records?

Beneficiaries have the right to see how the estate's money was spent. If you can't prove an expense was legitimate, you might have to pay it back yourself.

Detailed records also protect you from accusations of mismanagement.

How to use this log:

Record every expense, no matter how small. Include the date, what it was for, who was paid, and the amount. Keep the receipt or invoice. At the end, you'll have a complete record of all estate expenses.

Let's track it all.

Your Executor Expense Log Template

Track every dollar spent on the estate, so your final accounting is clean and defensible.

ESTATE DETAILS

ESTATE OF

EXECUTOR NAME

DATE ESTATE OPENED

EXPENSE LOG

> *Record every expense. Note whether you paid it personally (to be reimbursed) or from the estate account. Keep all receipts.*

DATE	DESCRIPTION	PAYEE	AMOUNT	PAID FROM	RECEIPT

Your Executor Expense Log Template (cont.)

DATE	DESCRIPTION	PAYEE	AMOUNT	PAID FROM	RECEIPT

Your Executor Expense Log Template (cont.)

DATE	DESCRIPTION	PAYEE	AMOUNT	PAID FROM	RECEIPT

TOTALS AND NOTES

Notification Templates

After someone dies, you need to notify dozens of organizations.

Banks. Retirement plan administrators. Social Security. Insurance companies. Employers. Tax authorities. Utilities. Each one
needs to be told formally, usually in writing.

This section provides letter templates you can adapt and use.

These templates are starting points. You'll need to customize them with specific details (names, account numbers, dates). But they give you the structure and wording to make notifications easier.

How to use these templates:

1. Choose the template that matches who you're notifying
2. Fill in the bracketed information with your details
3. Attach a certified copy of the death certificate
4. Keep a copy of every letter you send
5. Follow up if you don't hear back within 2 weeks

Let's make notifications easier.

NOTIFICATION TEMPLATES FOR EXECUTORS

TEMPLATE 1: NOTIFICATION TO BANK

[Your Name]
[Your Address]
[Your Phone]
[Your Email]

[Date]

[Bank Name]
[Branch Address]

To Whom It May Concern,

Re: Notification of Death - [Deceased's Full Name]

I am writing to notify you of the death of [Deceased's Full Name], who passed away on [Date of Death].

[Deceased's Name] held the following account(s) with your organization:
- Account Name: [Account Name]
- Account Number: [Account Number]
- routing number: [routing number]

I am the executor of the estate of [Deceased's Name]. A certified copy of the death certificate is enclosed.

Please freeze the account(s) and advise me of the balance(s) as at the date of death. I will provide a copy of the Letters Testamentary once it has been issued by the Probate court.

Please also advise if there are any:
- Direct debits or automatic payments linked to this account
- Joint account holders
- Loans, credit cards, or other products in the deceased's name

I would appreciate your response within 14 days.

Sincerely,

[Your Signature]
[Your Printed Name]
Executor for the Estate of [Deceased's Full Name]
Enclosures: Certified copy of death certificate

TEMPLATE 2: NOTIFICATION TO RETIREMENT SAVINGS FUND

[Your Name]
[Your Address]
[Your Phone]
[Your Email]

[Date]

[Retirement savings Fund Name]
[Retirement savings Fund Address]

To Whom It May Concern,

Re: Death Benefit Claim - [Deceased's Full Name]
Member Number: [Member Number]

I am writing to notify you of the death of [Deceased's Full Name], who passed away on [Date of Death].

[Deceased's Name] was a member of your retirement savings fund. A certified copy of the death certificate is enclosed.

Please send me:
1. A death benefit claim form
2. Details of the current retirement savings balance
3. Information about any beneficiary designation on file
4. Details of any insurance held through the fund (life insurance, TOTAL DISABILITY, disability insurance)

I am the executor of the estate. Please advise what documentation you require to process the death benefit claim.

I would appreciate your response within 14 days.

Sincerely,

[Your Signature]
[Your Printed Name]
Executor for the Estate of [Deceased's Full Name]

Enclosures: Certified copy of death certificate

TEMPLATE 3: NOTIFICATION TO Social Security

[Your Name]
[Your Address]
[Your Phone]

[Date]

Social Security
[Local Social Security Office Address]

To Whom It May Concern,

Re: Notification of Death - [Deceased's Full Name]
Social Security Reference Number (SSN): [SSN]

I am writing to notify you of the death of [Deceased's Full Name], who passed away on [Date of Death].

[Deceased's Name] was receiving the following payment(s):
- [Payment Type, e.g., Social Security, Caregiver benefits]

A certified copy of the death certificate is enclosed.

Please cease all payments with effect from [Date of Death] and advise if any payments received after this date need to be repaid.

[If applicable: The deceased's spouse, [Spouse's Name], SSN [Spouse's SSN], may be eligible for bereavement payments. Please advise them of any entitlements.]

Please confirm receipt of this notification and advise of any further action required.

Sincerely,

[Your Signature]
[Your Printed Name]
Executor for the Estate of [Deceased's Full Name]

Enclosures: Certified copy of death certificate

TEMPLATE 4: NOTIFICATION TO EMPLOYER

[Your Name]
[Your Address]
[Your Phone]
[Your Email]

[Date]

[Employer Name]
[HR Department]
[Employer Address]

To Whom It May Concern,

Re: Notification of Death - [Deceased's Full Name]
Employee Number: [Employee Number]

I am writing to notify you of the death of [Deceased's Full Name], who was employed by your organization as [Job Title]. [He/She] passed away on [Date of Death].

A certified copy of the death certificate is enclosed.

As the executor of [Deceased's Name]'s estate, I request the following:

1. Final pay for any unpaid salary or wages
2. Payment of accrued paid time off (PTO) and any other owed leave
3. Details of any retirement savings contributions owing
4. Information about any life insurance or disability insurance policies through the employer
5. Details of any other entitlements (severance, bonuses, share options, etc.)

Please advise what documentation you require and the expected timeframe for payment of final entitlements.

Please send all correspondence to the address above.

Sincerely,

[Your Signature]
[Your Printed Name]
Executor for the Estate of [Deceased's Full Name]

Enclosures: Certified copy of death certificate

TEMPLATE 5: NOTIFICATION TO INSURANCE COMPANY

[Your Name]
[Your Address]
[Your Phone]
[Your Email]

[Date]

[Insurance Company Name]
[Claims Department]
[Insurance Company Address]

To Whom It May Concern,

Re: Life Insurance Death Claim - [Deceased's Full Name]
Policy Number: [Policy Number]

I am writing to notify you of the death of [Deceased's Full Name], the insured person under the above policy. [He/She] passed away on [Date of Death].

A certified copy of the death certificate is enclosed.

I am the executor of the estate of [Deceased's Name]. Please send me:
1. A claim form for the death benefit
2. Confirmation of the sum insured
3. Details of the nominated beneficiaries (if any)
4. A list of documents required to process the claim

Please advise the expected timeframe for processing this claim.

I would appreciate your response within 14 days.

Sincerely,

[Your Signature]
[Your Printed Name]
Executor for the Estate of [Deceased's Full Name]

Enclosures: Certified copy of death certificate

TEMPLATE 6: NOTIFICATION TO UTILITY PROVIDER

[Your Name]
[Your Address]
[Your Phone]

[Date]

[Utility Provider Name]
[Utility Provider Address]

To Whom It May Concern,

Re: Notification of Death and Account Closure - [Deceased's Full Name]
Account Number: [Account Number]
Service Address: [Service Address]

I am writing to notify you of the death of [Deceased's Full Name], who passed away on [Date of Death].

[Deceased's Name] held an account with your organization for [electricity/gas/water/internet] service at the above address.

Please:
1. Transfer the account to my name as executor until the property is sold
OR
2. Close the account as of [Date] and send a final bill to the address below

Please send the final account statement and any refund owing to:
[Your Name]
[Your Address]

Sincerely,

[Your Signature]
[Your Printed Name]
Executor for the Estate of [Deceased's Full Name]

TEMPLATE 7: NOTIFICATION TO COUNTY/CITY PROPERTY TAX OFFICE

[Your Name]
[Your Address]
[Your Phone]

[Date]

[Tax Authority Name]
Property Tax Department
[Tax Authority Address]

To Whom It May Concern,

Re: Notification of Death - [Deceased's Full Name]
Property Address: [Property Address]
Parcel Number (APN): [Parcel Number (APN)]

I am writing to notify you of the death of [Deceased's Full Name], who was the owner of the above property. [He/She] passed away on [Date of Death].

I am the executor of the estate. A certified copy of the death certificate is enclosed.

Please update your records and send all future correspondence regarding this property to:
[Your Name]
[Your Address]

Please advise if there are any outstanding property taxes owing.

Sincerely,

[Your Signature]
[Your Printed Name]
Executor for the Estate of [Deceased's Full Name]

Enclosures: Certified copy of death certificate

TEMPLATE 8: GENERAL NOTIFICATION LETTER

[Your Name]
[Your Address]
[Your Phone]
[Your Email]

[Date]

[Organization Name]
[Organization Address]

To Whom It May Concern,

Re: Notification of Death - [Deceased's Full Name]
Account/Reference Number: [Number]

I am writing to notify you of the death of [Deceased's Full Name], who passed away on [Date of Death].

[Deceased's Name] held an account/membership/subscription with your organization. A certified copy of the death certificate is enclosed.

Please:
1. Close the account/cancel the membership/subscription
2. Advise if there are any outstanding payments or refunds owing
3. Update your records to prevent further correspondence

Please send any final statements or refunds to:
[Your Name]
[Your Address]

Sincerely,

[Your Signature]
[Your Printed Name]
Executor for the Estate of [Deceased's Full Name]

Enclosures: Certified copy of death certificate

TIPS FOR USING THESE TEMPLATES

- Always include a certified copy of the death certificate
- Keep a copy of every letter you send
- Record the date sent and follow up if no response within 2 weeks
- Use Certified Mail for important notifications
- Be clear about what you're requesting
- Include your contact details
- Be patient - some organizations take longer to respond than others

Your Notification Templates

A checklist of who to notify, and a place to track every notification you send.

WHO TO NOTIFY

- [ ] Banks (all accounts)
- [ ] Retirement plan administrators
- [ ] Social Security (if applicable)
- [ ] U.S. Department of Veterans Affairs (VA) (if applicable)
- [ ] Employer
- [ ] Life insurance companies
- [ ] Health insurance
- [ ] Home & contents insurance
- [ ] Car insurance
- [ ] County/city property tax office
- [ ] Electricity, gas and water providers
- [ ] Internet, phone and mobile providers
- [ ] Subscriptions (streaming, etc.)
- [ ] Gym / club memberships
- [ ] Professional associations
- [ ] Roadside assistance (AAA, etc.)
- [ ] USPS (redirect mail)
- [ ] County election office
- [ ] Medicare
- [ ] Internal Revenue Service (via accountant)

Your Notification Templates (cont.)

RECORD OF NOTIFICATIONS SENT

Log each notification and follow up if you don't hear back within 2 weeks.

ORGANIZATION	DATE SENT	RESPONSE RECEIVED?	FOLLOW-UP NEEDED?

Your Notification Templates (cont.)

ORGANIZATION	DATE SENT	RESPONSE RECEIVED?	FOLLOW-UP NEEDED?

NOTES

WHAT COMES NEXT

This is one part of the bigger picture.

The Executor Toolkit is Part IX of the full Estate Organizer. The complete book is where your family records everything an executor needs, long before it is needed.

- Personal, medical and key-contact details
- The Will, executor, guardianship and funeral wishes
- Every account, asset, debt and policy in one place
- Digital life, legacy letters and final records

Get the complete Estate Organizer

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